

A computer in the clouds

Amazon is big - there is no doubt about that. From selling everything, to providing within the hour delivery of everyday stuff, to delivering TV shows and movies to your phones and laptops, it offers a lot of services. One could say that it has solely popularised smart speakers with the Echo devices. But there is another part of Amazon that not many know about, and yet it's the fastest growing business within Amazon with the highest operating income. We are talking about AWS.

Amazon Web Services is that division of Amazon which essentially provides cloud computing services. Yes, we did oversimplify when we said that - AWS provides almost every cloud-based service under the sun across its broad product portfolio. You can buy storage space to hold a huge database, bandwidth to host a website, or processing power to run complex AI workloads. AWS helps companies and individuals, big and small, to stop worrying about the infrastructure and enables them to implement their ideas exactly as they'd want to.

Earlier this year, when Amazon posted its earnings, it was evident that AWS was over three times as big as its nearest competitor. From early adopters like Netflix to big names such as Adobe, Airbnb, IMDb, Samsung, Ubisoft and many more, AWS is used by everyone. It is the popular belief that AWS runs the internet. While that may not essentially be true, and AWS might be a big fish swimming in an enormous ocean, there's no denying the true possibility of what can be accomplished with their services - many of which are available for you to try for free!

And that is what this book is all about. From introducing you to the complex AWS portfolio to taking you through what it means to have a completely operational application in the cloud, this FastTrack aims to be the one - and only - starting point you'll ever need to the amazing (and mind boggling) world of Amazon Web Services. 